

1. Can you describe your role in relation to the research project or projects you have been involved in?

I was the project lead for the Cocoa track. I helped coordinate the team's work, stayed in contact with stakeholders together with others, and supported the group in keeping the project on schedule

2. At the start of the project, what guidance were you given about how you were expected to document your research work? Can you give an example?

We were encouraged to keep our materials in shared spaces so the team could access them when needed. Beyond that, the approach developed naturally as we collaborated

3. Can you describe specific situations where documentation came up during the project work? What happened in those moments?

Documentation usually became relevant when we tried to bring our ideas together into something coherent. Putting things into writing helped align everyone's understanding.

4. Based on the final outputs of projects, how usable do you think they are for someone new who has not spoken to you? Can you give an example?

The report is readable, but not very easy to reuse. Someone can see the conclusions, but not exactly how I got there. For example, interviews and sources are mentioned, but the steps in between are not always clear. Without talking to me, it would be difficult to continue the work.

5. Which parts would be difficult for someone new to understand based only on what is written down or stored?

The reasons behind decisions. Why I chose one direction and not another. Also assumptions made about the cocoa chain are not always written down.

6. Can you think of an example of an important decision or change during the project, and describe how and where it was documented, if at all?

The scope of the project changed during the process because of time and data limits. This decision was not clearly documented as a decision. It only shows in the final report that the focus is smaller, without further note.

7. If someone new wanted to understand how one important conclusion was reached, what would they need to look at or read?

They would need more than just the report. They would need notes, drafts, and maybe extra explanation.

8. During the project, was it clear who was responsible for documenting what, if anyone? How was that responsibility communicated or decided?

We treated documentation as a collective effort of necessity and task assignment. Everyone contributed in their own way as the project moved forward.

9. What tools, templates, or systems were used to document work, and where was everything stored in practice?

Mainly Word documents and google folders. There was no fixed template or system for documentation. Things were stored in different places, like drafts, notes, and documents, which made it a bit messy.

10. What do you think the purpose of documentation is in these projects? Who do you think benefits from it, if anyone? And what, if anything, motivates students to document their work well?

Documentation should make the research understandable for others. Especially for future students or supervisors. In practice, motivation mainly comes from assessment. If documentation is not clearly graded or required, it is easier to focus on finishing the project instead.

11. Based on your experience, what tends to get lost most often over time, for example context, assumptions, decisions, data, analysis steps, or contacts?

After some time, it is harder to see how the team's conversations shaped the direction we took. What stays visible is the final work, but not always how everyone's input contributed to it.

12. How did documentation fit into the project work overall? Did it feel integrated into the work, or more like something added on top? Why?

Our main focus was developing the work together, so writing usually happened after those discussions rather than during them. It kind of followed the project inherently,

13. If you were starting the project again, what would you personally do differently in how you document your work?

I would try to capture important discussions earlier, so it stays clearer how the team reached certain ideas.

14. Is there anything about documentation, continuity, or research practice that we have not discussed but that you think is important?

Something I noticed is that when projects move from one team to another, small pieces of practical knowledge are not always carried forward. Having a simple way to pass that on would make it easier for the next group to continue without starting from zero